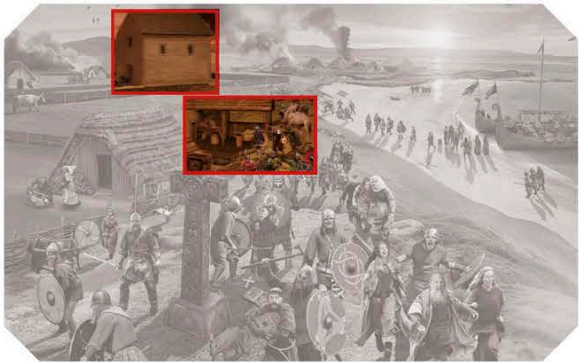


ST. CUTHBERT



Some 100 years before the Viking raid in 793, King Oswald of Northumbria in northern England made a monk called Cuthbert Bishop of Lindisfarne. After Cuthbert died, many miracles were reported by people who prayed at his tomb in Lindisfarne. Within a few years, the island monastery was attracting thousands of Christian pilgrims.



Anglo-Saxon churches are beautifully decorated inside, with painted walls and arches.

Center of devotion

The grandest of several churches in the monastery complex, the main church was the busy heart of the community. Monks attended prayers here throughout the day, and a steady stream of visitors came to pay their respects at the shrine of St. Cuthbert.

This Viking is about to catch a fleeing monk.



The altar is covered with golden candlesticks and crucifixes, prime targets for the Vikings.



Treasure chest

Churches kept their most precious objects in highly ornate chests. This example from Italy is made of silver and decorated with religious figures.

Novice monks snatch up precious scrolls to try and protect them from the Vikings.

LIFE ON LINDISFARNE

The island of Lindisfarne is tiny, but the monastery is famous in the Christian world. Thousands visit to pray and admire the monks' work— beautiful scriptures and richly decorated religious objects. Surrounding the monastery is a busy, prosperous village that is, however, undefended. To the Vikings, the island is the perfect target.

Lindisfarne Gospels

This spectacular book decorated with exquisite calligraphy is believed to be the work of a monk called Eadfrith. It still survives today, only the cover (said to have been covered with gold and jewels) is missing. It may have been stolen in the Viking raid.

